



GREAT LAKES INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT, GURGAON
Post Graduate Diploma in Management | PGDM 2025–27

SUMMER INTERNSHIP PROJECT REPORT

SUMMER INTERNSHIP PROJECT REPORT

PROJECT TITLE

Architecting Financial Intelligence at Paytm Through the Lens of Revenue Assurance and Analytics

SUBMITTED BY
Tarana Bansal

Roll Number
P2513070

Batch / Section
PGDM 2025-27

Specialization / Domain
Finance, Analytics

Email Address
tarana.pgdm27g@greatlakes.edu.in

Contact Number
9958262885

COMPANY DETAILS

Company Name
Paytm, One97 Communications Limited

Industry / Sector
Fintech

Location
One Skymark, Sector-98, Noida-201304

Company Guide Name & Designation
Sanchit Aggarwal, General Manager

FACULTY MENTOR

Faculty Mentor Name
Prof. Jyoti Garg

Designation
Assistant Professor

Department
Accounting and Finance

SUBMISSION DETAILS

Date of Submission
19-06-2026

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to extend my heartfelt gratitude to everyone who has played a role in the successful completion of this internship. Everyone's support and guidance was crucial.

I would like to extend my deepest gratitude to Ms. Jyoti Garg first, our mentor and supporter who always encouraged us to do our best in the Internship. I would then like to extend my heartfelt gratitude to my direct reporting manager and GM of Revenue Assurance department, Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal for guiding me and to my Managers, Mr. Amandeep Singh and Ms. Priyam Srivastava. I am truly thankful for all others, including but not limited to, Mr. Ankit Chandra, Mr. Ashwini Singh, Mr. Abhishek Gupta, Mr. Namandeep Singh, Ms. Anshu Vyas and Ms. Neha Agrawal.

I would also like to thank Great Lakes Institute of Management, Gurgaon, for giving me this opportunity along with our placement head, Dr. Vidya, who were extremely encouraging throughout.

The unwavering support, valuable feedback and insights received helped me significantly improve my work and also gave me space to learn from both failures and new opportunities. Everyone was a great motivation during the period, including but not limited to: my family, friends, peers, managers and Paytm itself, for letting me undertake this amazing journey.

CERTIFICATE OF ORIGINALITY AND AUTHENTICITY

I hereby declare that the project report titled “Architecting Financial Intelligence at Paytm: Through the lens of Revenue Assurance and Analytics” submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) at Great Lakes Institute of Management, Gurgaon, is my original work.

The study has been carried out during my Summer Internship at Paytm, One Communications Limited, under the guidance of the company mentor Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal and faculty guide Prof. Jyoti Garg. The information, analysis, findings and interpretations presented in this report are based on my internship observations, stakeholder interactions, secondary research and academic analysis.

I further declare that this report has not been submitted wholly or partly to any other institution or university for the award of any degree, diploma or certificate.

Wherever information from published or unpublished sources has been used, appropriate acknowledgement and references have been provided.

Date: 2nd June, 2026

Place: Noida, Uttar Pradesh

Signature:

Tarana Bansal

P2513070

PGDM 2025 - 27

Great Lakes Institute of Management, Gurgaon

CERTIFICATE

It is certified that Ms Tarana Bansal, a PG student of Great Lakes Institute of Management, Gurgaon has undergone a Summer Internship at Paytm from 2nd April to 2nd June, 2026.

Her project titled “Architecting Financial Intelligence at Paytm: Through the lens of Revenue Assurance and Analytics” has been completed to our satisfaction and the present report is a bona fide account of the same.

Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal
General Manager at Paytm
Date: 2nd June, 2026

Ms. Jyoti Garg
(Assistant Professor in Finance)
Date: 19th June, 2026



TABLE OF CONTENTS

Executive Summary	07
Internship Arc: From Operations to Intelligence	07
Key Outcomes	08
Chapter 1 - The Business Context	09
1.1 Introduction	09
1.2 The Core Business Challenge	09
1.3 Internship Commencement	10
1.4 First Week Observations: Seeds of Every Subsequent Initiative	11
Chapter 2 – Objectives and Industry Analysis	12
Part A: Objectives	12
2.1 Primary Objective	12
2.2 Secondary Objective	12
Part B: Industry Analysis	13
2.3 Fintech Industry Overview	13
2.4 Paytm: Company Overview	13
2.5 PESTLE Analysis	13
2.6 Porter’s 5 forces	14
2.7 SWOT Analysis	14
2.8 Industry Outlook	14
Chapter 3 - Ageing Analysis & Working Capital Management (Learnings in Finance)	14
3.1 The Working Capital Lens	14
3.2 Ageing Analysis Framework	15
3.3 Days Sales Outstanding (DSO): The Efficiency Metric	16
3.4 Provision for Doubtful Debts (PDD)	17
3.5 A Note on Attempted Automation: Treasury Reconciliation	18
Chapter 4 - ETA Analytics & Collections Automation	19
4.1 From Historical Reporting to Predictive Collections	19
4.2 The Architecture of ETA vs Collections	19
4.3 Identifying the Business Gap	20
4.4 Business Impact	22

Chapter 5 - Executive Reporting & Debtor MIS Transformation	23
5.1 From Collection Operations to Executive Decision Support	23
5.2 Strategic Questions Addressed by Debtor MIS	23
5.3 Working Capital Metrics Monitored	23
5.4 VBA Based Remarks Generation Utility	25
Chapter 6 - Manual Processes to Intelligent Automation	26
Part A: Internal Workflow Ticketing System	26
6.1 Business Problem and its Solution	26
6.2 Role Based Architecture	27
6.3 Ticket Lifecycle	27
Part B: Recovery Notice Automation	28
6.4 Automation as a Business Enabler	28
6.5 Recovery Notice Automation	29
Chapter 7 - Payment Application & Reconciliation	30
7.1 Beyond Collections: Ensuring Cash Realisation	30
7.2 End-to-End Payment Application Process	30
7.3 Daily Verification Activities	30
Chapter 8 - Organisational Value Created & Personal Learnings	32
8.1 Quantified Impact	32
8.2 Skills & Knowledge Acquired	33
8.3 Contributions Delivered	33
8.4 Professional Insights: What the Internship Actually Taught	33
Management Innovation	34
Risks, Limitations & Personal Learnings	35
Recommendations for Paytm	36
Final Conclusion	37
Appendix: QR Repository	38
Glimpses of Achievement	38
Bibliography	39
Course Mapping	40

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Finance functions do not typically struggle because of insufficient data, they fail because critical information exists in disconnected department systems that delay decision-making. During my Summer Internship with Paytm's Revenue Assurance & Collections Team, I found this operational hindrance and tried to focus on bridging this gap by combining collections analytics, process automation and management reporting into an integrated Collections Intelligence Ecosystem.

Internship Arc: From Operations to Intelligence

Stage	Initiative	Status	Impact
1	Recovery notice automation: first assigned task	Live	83% time reduction per notice
2	Collections process learning & ageing familiarisation	Complete	Foundation for all finance knowledge (working capital) and analytics
3	Ageing analysis & working capital framework	Live	Monthly MIS enhanced (Automatic Remarks generation using VBA Macros)
4	ETA Analytics: ETA vs Collections framework	Live	30 hrs/month saved (Manual drafting eliminated)
5	VBA Remarks Engine for monthly MIS	Live	4 hrs → <1 min per cycle
6	Internal ticketing & Workflow Management system	Live	Accountability framework for employees
7	Knowledge transfer to PPSL RA intern	Complete	Framework independently replicated

Key Outcomes

80 hrs Saved per month <i>i.e. 2 FTE weeks</i>	99.6% MIS remarks time cut <i>4 hrs → <1 min</i>	83% Recovery notice time cut <i>3 hrs → 30 min</i>	₹4.1 Cr Receivables governed <i>Mar '26</i>
---	--	---	--

My internship began with operational responsibilities, i.e., Automations, like Recovery Notice Management and simple feedback analysis of customer communication, but progressively evolved, after seeing my calibre, into building analytical frameworks and automation solutions that supported

Executive Reporting and Collections Governance. Exposure to end-to-end receivables management enabled a deeper understanding of ageing analysis, payment application, working capital monitoring and collection forecasting.

A major outcome was the development and enhancement of an ETA (Expected Time of Arrival) vs Collections framework that connected collection commitments with actual realisations, automating email sending to various stakeholders including those who had got their targets, including HODs and Level 3 Managers. The practical value was seen when another intern from PPSL was assigned to me to prepare a similar automation for that RA Department and understand the automation architecture for future scalability.

A VBA-based remarks generation utility was also developed that automatically generated management commentary based on preliminary datasets, reducing repetitive manual effort while ensuring reporting consistency. Apart from Recovery Notices then, also worked on Internal Workflow Ticketing for Direct Manager and GM, Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal to assign tickets and ensure smoother workflow deadline achievements.

Alongside automation initiatives, active involvement in the monthly Debtor MIS process provided exposure to executive reporting used for monitoring receivables, Days Sales Outstanding (DSO), ageing movements and Provision for Doubtful Debts (PDD). The internship thus ultimately evolved from learning finance operations to contributing process improvements that enhanced collections governance, reporting quality and decision support. Collectively, the initiatives demonstrated how analytics and automation can strengthen Working Capital Management by improving visibility into receivables, accelerating reporting cycles and enabling proactive collection monitoring.

Collections Intelligence Ecosystem

Rather than functioning as isolated operational activities, recovery management, ageing analysis, collection forecasting and management reporting were integrated into a unified collections intelligence framework capable of supporting faster reviews, improved governance and stronger working capital visibility.

Executive Collections Dashboard

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
3		Total Debtors (Onus)	Total PDD (Mar'26)	Overall DSO (Mar'26)	>90 Days Dues	Collections March'26	GL Recon Status			
4	ONUS>>	₹ 4.1 Cr GL: ₹4.7 Cr Δ: 0.9 Cr	₹ 1.3 Cr ↓ 1.3 Cr MoM	54 Days vs 53 Days (Feb'26)	₹ 1.9 Cr ↓ ₹1.2 Cr MoM	₹ 1.8 Cr 1.22x Monthly Billing	MATCHED ✓ ₹4.7 Cr			
5										
6										
7										

Figure ES 1 Executive Collections Dashboard

CHAPTER 1: BUSINESS CONTEXT

1.1 Introduction

Revenue Assurance & Collections is the intersection of Finance, Operations and Customer Management within Paytm's One97 Communications Limited. The function is responsible for monitoring receivables across Paytm's Advertising, FMCG, D2C, Cashback, Government and Bus operations portfolios, ensuring that revenue already earned through services provided in the previous months is converted into cash efficiently, accurately and within acceptable timeframes. Poor collections governance does not just affect cash flow, it directly increases Days Sales Outstanding, inflating provisioning requirements and affecting reported profitability (EBITDA).

On joining the team, I noticed that the people within the Ads RA department were extremely skilled and experienced, but were spending a lot of their time compiling information from various sources for various reporting data, rather than actionising on strategy to improve collections. That structural inefficiency was the problem I identified and related outcomes were expected by my managers as the company was quite stringent on Automation and AI.

1.2 The Core Business Challenge

What Existed	Reality	Business Consequence
Data	Spread across SAP exports, individual Excel trackers and Google Sheets maintained by different team members	No single version of truth, mismatches between versions (sometimes hours went by rectifying one error)
Processes	Each governance cycle executed manually from scratch, compile, VLOOKUP, update, distribute	2+ days consumed before any analysis could begin
Governance	Email-dependent, person-specific follow-ups with no accountability or audit trail	Tasks went over deadline without accountability: no escalation trigger

The Problem in One Sentence

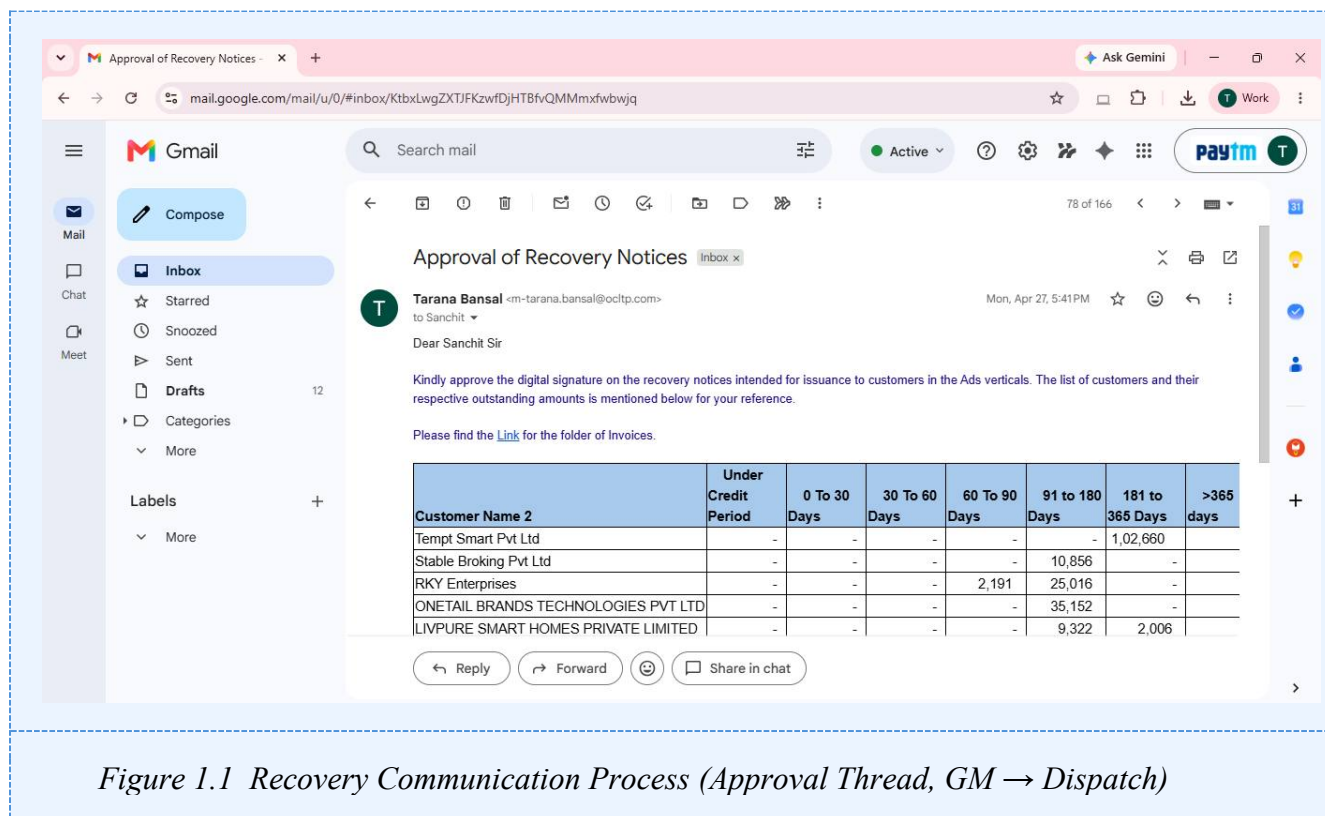
Compiling data, processes and reviews into decision ready intelligence required manual effort, which was becoming hectic and cumbersome for both the employees and the company

1.3 Internship Commencement

My internship commenced with Recovery Notice Automation. Approximately 40 formal overdue payment notices are issued per quarter to Advertising customers. Each notice required approximately 3 hours of effort before automation:

- Downloading customer specific documentation from SAP (outstanding invoices, account statements)
- Manually making the annexure table: customer name, invoice references, amounts by ageing bucket
- Drafting the notice body in Paytm's official format with correct outstanding figures
- Obtaining GM approval and dispatching through the official receivables email id

A third - party mail merge software was previously used for this process but it was slower than manual, both because of platform limitations and the time required to correctly format SAP attachments alongside the merged content. It was thus discontinued in Feb 2026. This showed that they had tried it, but found the available tools hectic and had reverted to manual. The challenge was to build something simpler, faster and embedded in tools the team already used.



1.4 First Week Observations: Seeds of Every Subsequent Initiative

Within the first two weeks, sitting alongside people from Collections reviews, management meetings and daily operations, several recurring things became visible to me:

- The ETA tracker and the collections tracker were maintained separately, no dynamic dashboards to inform in a glance whether committed targets were being met or not, Pivots had to be created separately/ Payment Application checked, but mostly it was all memorised
- Monthly MIS preparation took a full day of compilation followed by 4 hours of manual comments writing, my manager thus wanted a way to reduce his workload
- Reminder emails were drafted individually for each portfolio lead, each review cycle, 4 times every month along with separate emails for HOD and senior managers
- There was no central place to track who was responsible for which follow up action or what its status was, everything existed only in memory, thus the long time in handover (if necessary)

These observations, accumulated through interactions with Mr. Ankit Chandra, Mr. Ashwini, Mr. Amandeep Singh, Mr. Mayank Bansal, Ms. Priyam Srivastava and others across the team, formed the blueprint. These were built by listening carefully, asking questions, learning financial concepts like Working Capital Management, Payment Application, etc. and then applying Excel, VBA, Apps Script and process design to reduce workload and easier analysis.

Operational Learning

Enterprise scale finance processes often contain enormous efficiency reserves, not because the people running them are unaware of the inefficiency, but because the available tools are either paid/ too complex or have not kept pace with the current skillsets. The gap between 'what exists' and 'what is possible with the same tools used differently' is where the Analytical and Automation skills created the utmost value.

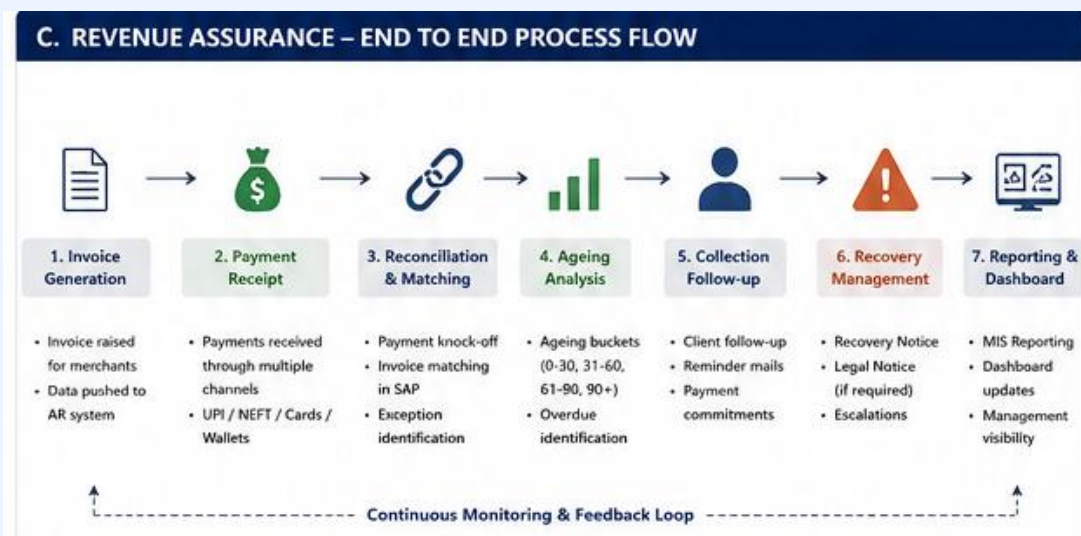


Figure 1.2 Revenue Assurance in a snapshot

CHAPTER 2: OBJECTIVE AND INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

PART A: OBJECTIVES

2.1 Primary Objective

To identify and close operational gaps in Paytm's Revenue Assurance and Collections processes across accounts receivable tracking, recovery management and executive reporting through automation driven solutions that improve collection efficiency, reporting visibility and financial control.

2.2 Secondary Objectives

- To understand the Accounts Receivables lifecycle, from invoice generation through ageing analysis to final reconciliation
- To examine where manual effort in recovery notice preparation, MIS compilation and follow up tracking was creating bottlenecks and assess which of these were genuinely automatable versus structurally fixed (e.g. SAP dependent steps)
- To design and deploy an ETA vs Collections framework capable of comparing committed and realised collections without monthly manual construction
- To reduce the time and inconsistency involved in monthly Debtor MIS preparation, particularly management commentary, through macros based automation
- To introduce a centralised, role based tracking mechanism for recovery actions and escalations in place of informal, memory dependent follow ups
- To apply AI assisted tools (Claude, ChatGPT) and scripting (VBA, Google Apps Script) towards formula generation, data processing and report automation within a live finance function

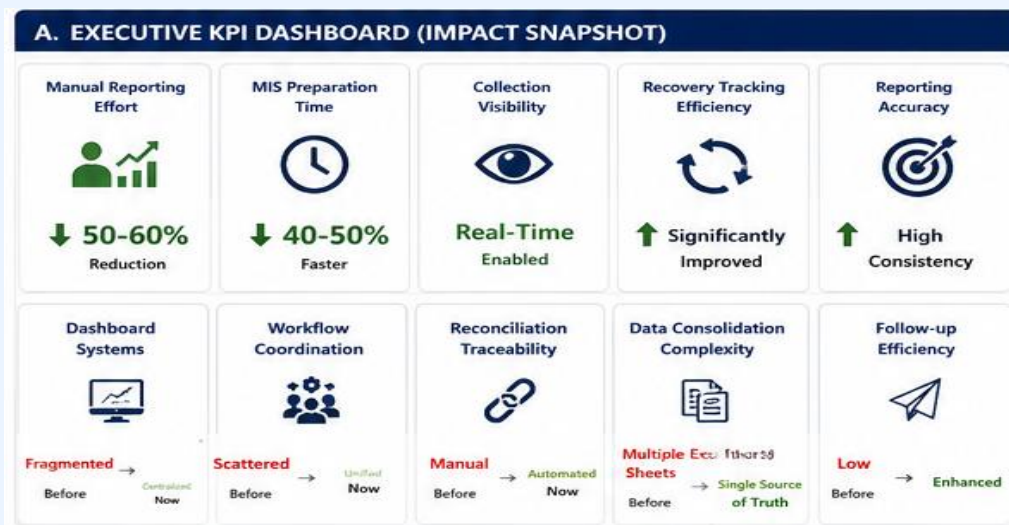


Figure 2.1 Objectives undertaken in a snapshot

2.3 Fintech Industry Overview

India's UPI network now processes over 23 billion payments a month worth roughly ₹30 lakh crore, making it the world's largest real time payments system and the backbone of the country's Fintech sector. The market remains led by Paytm, PhonePe, Razorpay, CRED, and Policybazaar, but concentration is loosening: the combined share of the top three UPI apps: PhonePe, Google Pay and Paytm fell from 95.2% in January 2024 to 87% by May 2026, as smaller players gained ground ahead of NPCI's mandated 30% single app cap. [Source: Outlook Business (2026, June)]

2.4 Paytm: Company Overview

Paytm (One97 Communications Limited) operates across UPI payments, merchant solutions, advertising, lending, insurance, etc. Despite once being the UPI market leader, Paytm now holds a roughly 6% share of UPI transaction volume, trailing PhonePe and Google Pay by a wide margin.

2.5 PESTLE Analysis

Factors	External Force
Political	RBI's evolving regulatory stance on digital payments and data localisation (RBI's direct supervisory action against Paytm Payments Bank, including a ban on accepting fresh deposits and credit transactions effective February 29, 2024)
Economic	Macroeconomic push toward a cashless economy, increased fintech investment inflows (expanding transaction volumes sector wide)
Social	Demographic shift toward app first, digital first financial behaviour, especially outside metro India, expanding the merchant and consumer base every platform must service
Legal	Tightening data protection (DPDP Act) and KYC/AML compliance requirements
Environmental	Regulatory and ESG pressure accelerating the shift to paperless financial documentation
Technological	Underlying infrastructure shift (cloud, AI, real-time rails) that all players must adapt to, not build themselves

2.6 Porter's 5 Forces

Force	Intensity	Structural Reason
-------	-----------	-------------------

Competitive Rivalry	High	PhonePe and Google Pay together still hold close to 79% of UPI volume, leaving the remaining players to compete intensely for a shrinking residual share (chasing the same merchant pool)
Buyer Power	High	Near zero switching cost for merchants and consumers between UPI enabled platforms
Threat of Substitutes	High	No single platform has structural lock in over users or merchants, except for their unique propositions
Threat of New Entrants	Moderate	RBI licensing and compliance costs create a real, but not prohibitive, barrier, evidenced by newer entrants like Navi, super.money and CRED steadily gaining share
Supplier Power	Moderate	Settlement ultimately runs through NPCI and partner banks, a dependency no fintech player controls directly

2.7 SWOT Analysis

Dimension	Paytm
Strengths	Largest merchant network among Indian fintechs, first mover brand recognition in QR/UPI payments
Weaknesses	History of regulatory friction, eroded UPI market position (from market leader to roughly 6% share and closing of Paytm Payments bank entirely on April 24, 2026), materially disrupting its banking operations and brand trust [Source: TaxGuru (2024, January 31). <i>RBI Restricts Paytm Payments Bank from 29th February 2024</i>]
Opportunities	Cross selling lending, insurance and merchant financial services into its existing merchant base; tightening collections and revenue assurance to protect margin while volume growth slows relative to rivals
Threats	Continued regulatory scrutiny stemming from its compliance history, well capitalised rivals converting their UPI dominance into broader product cross sell

2.8 Industry Outlook

Fintech in India will keep expanding, but the basis of competition is shifting from first acquisitions to operational trust: who reconciles, collects and reports accurately at scale, especially as NPCI's market cap rules push volume away from the current leaders and toward firms that can convert smaller volumes into reliable, well governed revenue.

CHAPTER 3: AGEING ANALYSIS & WORKING CAPITAL MANAGEMENT (LEARNING THE FINANCIAL ARCHITECTURE OF COLLECTIONS)

3.1 The Working Capital Lens

Collections management is often defined as being able to recover overdue amounts. The more accurate framing is financial: every rupee sitting in outstanding receivables (earned only after billing it) is a rupee that has been earned but cannot yet be deployed in operations, invested or returned to shareholders. The ageing of those receivables directly determines the cost of that delay.

Management Principle

At ₹1.5 Cr average monthly billing and an 8% cost of capital: every 1 day improvement in DSO frees ₹0.05 Cr and saves approximately ₹4 lakhs annually in implied financing cost. A 10 day DSO improvement frees ₹0.5 Cr. The Advertising vertical's DSO improvement from 33 days to 12 days across FY26 implies a working capital release of over ₹15 Cr equivalent and an annualised interest saving of ₹1.27 Cr.

~ Mr. Ankit Chandra

3.2 Ageing Analysis Framework

Stage	Activity
1. Identification	Map all overdue invoices to customer, vertical, POD lead and due date
2. Bucket Monitoring	Classify outstanding balances into standard intervals: 0 - 30, 31 - 60, 61 - 90, 91 - 180, 181 - 365, >365 days
3. Migration Tracking	Compare current month buckets against prior month, identify which balances moved to higher risk bands/ Legal
4. Delay Analysis	Investigate root causes for balances that moved adversely: disputes, billing errors, customer UTR not matching
5. Management Review	Present consolidated ageing dashboard to senior leadership, commit to recovery actions

The review process involved identifying overdue invoices, monitoring bucket migration, tracking changes across reporting periods, understanding reasons for delayed realisation, escalating high risk accounts and supporting monthly management reviews. Through repeated monthly ageing exercises, I developed a practical understanding of how receivables evolve over time and how ageing directly impacts business decisions through repeated monthly ageing Excel preparation.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	POD Lead Name	Feb	Mar	Apr	No ETA	Grand Total	
2	Anand Shankar	5.54	4.04	0.65	-	10.23	
3	Avijit Tibrewal	-	0.01	-	-	0.01	
4	Deepinder Singh	0.71	0.65	-	-	1.35	
5	Sagar Gansalva	-	-	-	-	-	
6	Shreya Sharma	1.33	1.01	-	-	2.34	
7	Sumit Verma	3.62	3.23	0.00	0.26	7.11	
8	Susmita Koushta	-	-	-	-	-	
9	Yashika	7.00	19.38	0.01	0.02	26.42	
10	Trishna Rana	-	0.15	-	-	0.15	
11	Legal	-	-	-	-	-	
12	Grand Total	###	###	##	0.28	47.60	
13							

Figure 3.1 Monthly Receivable Ageing Dashboard (POD lead × month pivot)

Executive Interpretation

The ageing dashboard converted transactional records into a decision support framework by highlighting concentration of receivables across ageing buckets varied by account POD Leads. This enabled collections teams to prioritise interventions based on the amount, risk and transaction volume, while communicating to various POD Leads for their performance.

3.3 Days Sales Outstanding (DSO): The Efficiency Metric

Ageing analysis was complemented by continuous monitoring of Days Sales Outstanding (DSO), one of the most widely used indicators for evaluating Receivable efficiency. Rather than focusing solely on outstanding balances, DSO measures the average number of days required to convert sales into cash. Ageing analysis was complemented by continuous DSO monitoring across all business verticals. DSO was tracked quarterly from Q1 FY26 through Q4 FY26, the team then was able to evaluate collection effectiveness over time and identify portfolios requiring focused governance. The table below reflects figures from the DSO analysis conducted during my internship (all figures are fictional).

Vertical	Q1 FY26	Q2 FY26	Q3 FY26	Q4 FY26 (Mar'26)	Trend	Assessment
Advertising	33 days	33 days	31 days	12 days	Sharp ↓	Sustained governance, remarkable improvement

Cashback	34 days	16 days	31 days	24 days	Improving	Successful targeted recovery
Bus Operations	23 days	36 days	15 days	18 days	Stable	Efficient billing cycle, low risk portfolio
Paytm First Travel	37 days	17 days	18 days	42 days	Volatile	High DSO history; continued monitoring needed
FMCG (North)	—	—	—	33 days	Baseline	Benchmark established this period
CDIT + BFSI	—	—	—	44 days	Monitor	Above 30-day threshold; focus area

Index		Clear Billed Dues DSO														
		Q1 FY26 (Jun25)			Q2 FY26 (Sep25)			Q3 FY26 (Dec25)			Q4 FY26 (Feb 26)			Q4 FY26 (Mar 26)		
		Total dues	Monthly avg billing	DSO	Total dues	Monthly avg billing	DSO	Total dues	Monthly avg billing	DSO	Total dues	Monthly avg billing	DSO	Total dues	Monthly avg billing	DSO
9	HRB	2.5	0.2	331	2.2	0.2	330	2.1	0.2	312	0.5	0.5	33	0.3	0.9	12
10	HRB	1.9	1.7	34	1.7	3.2	16	2.5	2.4	31	6.0	4.1	44	3.4	4.2	24
11	HRB	7.8	10.2	23	11.4	9.5	36	4.7	9.4	15	6.3	9.4	20	4.5	7.7	18
12	Paytm First Travel	2.9	0.2	371	2.8	0.0	1728	2.9	0.1	0	0.2	0.1	0	0.2	0.1	0
13	HRB	1.5	3.0	15	1.5	1.4	33	1.6	1.4	33	3.4	2.1	49	7.8	5.5	42
14	HRB C&L	4.8	4.8	30	0.0	46.4	0	0.0	0.0	0	0.0	0.0	0	0.0	0.0	0
15	Total	20.08	20.08	19.72	60.70	60.70	13.78	13.44	16.42	16.18	0.00	16.27	18.40	0	0	0

Figure 3.2 Business-wise DSO Analysis

3.4 Provision for Doubtful Debts (PDD)

Ageing analysis was then followed by Provision for Doubtful Debts (PDD), where receivables are evaluated for potential customers that might default. The PDD framework highlighted the importance of timely collections by showing how recurring overdue balances transform into provisioning requirements.

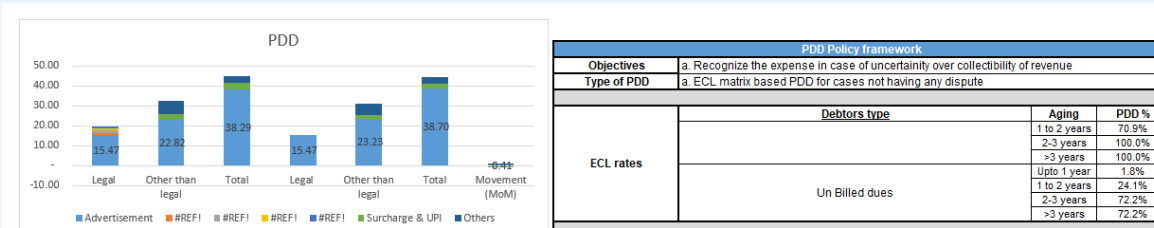


Figure 3.3 Provision for Doubtful Debts Monitoring (Mar'26)

3.5 A Note on Attempted Automation: Treasury Reconciliation

I attempted automating the treasury reconciliation process, the step by which collected amounts are formally transferred from collections to the treasury team. This, however, proved infeasible as the reconciliation process ran entirely through SAP, with no API or accessible interface that could be automated from outside the system. This failure, however, taught me a lot of new frameworks, including Python and helped assess which projects should be taken up in the future.

Chapter Highlights:

- ✓ Learnt ageing analysis and bucket management
- ✓ Understood relationship between receivables and working capital
- ✓ Developed practical understanding of DSO monitoring across verticals, gained exposure to PDD
- ✓ Learnt not all endeavours are successful, but they teach a lot more than successes
- ✓ Participated in monthly finance reviews with senior management
- ✓ Built the analytical foundation for subsequent automation initiatives

CHAPTER 4: ETA ANALYSIS & COLLECTIONS MANAGEMENT

4.1 From Historical Reporting to Predictive Collections

After a month, I developed a strong understanding of ageing analysis and receivable behaviour. Another operational challenge then became apparent: Collection commitments were maintained separately from realised collections as ETA given by Business was followed. Follow up emails were drafted manually, reminders were dependent on individual users and portfolio reviews required repeated consolidation from multiple sources.

4.2 The Architecture of ETA vs Collections

The framework was designed around a single principle: the only manual input required each month should be entering collections as they arrive. Everything else: analysis, classification, email drafting and stakeholder communication to happen automatically.

Component	Before	After
Data assembly	4 day multi - file VLOOKUP process	Collections updated as received, all lookups internal to the framework
Performance classification	Manual assessment per lead	Automatic: $\geq 100\%$ green, 95 - 99% blue, 85 - 94% amber; $< 85\%$ red; Future ETA tracked
Dashboard	Reconstructed each cycle from scratch	Auto refreshes on data entry, month selector option for historical views
Email: start of month	Manually drafted for HOD + all POD leads	One click, auto populates portfolio data per recipient
Email: mid - month review	Manually drafted per underperformer	Auto generated from classification results
Email: month - end closing	Manually drafted for all stakeholders	One click, includes final achievement summary
Recipient management	Re-entered every cycle	Config sheet: names, emails, CC designations stored once, applied permanently

2	COLLECTIONS DASHBOARD · MAY · ALL EMAILS					09 Jun 2026 · 04:21
3	Billing Reference: Feb · Mar · Apr All amounts in Crores (₹ Cr)					
5	● ≥100% On Target ● 95-99% Near Target ● <95% Below Target					
7	KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS — MAY					
8	Portfolio Outstanding	ETA Received (May)	Collected vs ETA	Future ETA Collected	Still to Collect	Rollover from Apr
9	₹0.41 Cr	₹0.15 Cr	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.00 Cr	₹0.14 Cr	None
10	7 leads	Coverage: —	Achievement: 9%	Carry-forward receipts	2 leads below 95%	1 lead >100%
12						
13						
14	EMAIL 1 — HOD + POD Leads (Start of Month)					
15	Sent to: Anshul + all POD leads · Subject: May Collections Dashboard — ETA Overview					

Figure 4.1 ETA vs Collections Dashboard (May'26)

52	Total Outstanding	ETA Received (May)	Collection — Current Month ETA	Collection — Future ETA	% Achievement	Unpaid Pending
53	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.00 Cr	100%	—
54						
55						
56	▶ Deepinder Singh					
58	i ETA commitment: ₹0.01 Cr Collected (current ETA): ₹0.00 Cr Achievement: 0% ⚠ Pending (1 acct): ₹0.01 Cr					
59						
60	Total Outstanding	ETA Received (May)	Collection — Current Month ETA	Collection — Future ETA	% Achievement	Unpaid Pending
61	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.01 Cr	₹0.00 Cr	₹0.00 Cr	0%	₹0.01 Cr
62						
63	⚠ Pending Accounts — May ETA					
64	#	Customer Name	ETA Target (May)	Collected	Pending	
65	1	Intelliglobe Travel Tech Pvt Ltd	₹0.01 Cr	Not Received	₹0.01 Cr	
66	Total Pending (1 account)		₹0.01 Cr	₹0.00 Cr	₹0.01 Cr	
67						
68						
69	EMAIL 4 — HOD + POD Leads + Finance (Month-End Closing)					
70	Sent to: Anshul + all POD leads + Finance · Subject: May Collections Closing — All Stakeholders					
72						

Figure 4.2 Weekly ETA Monitoring Dashboard

4.3 Identifying the Business Gap

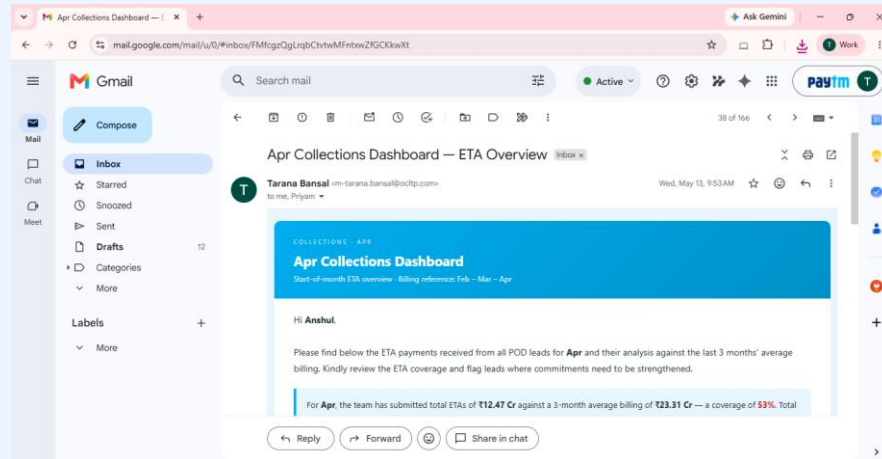
Although ETA commitments existed, comparing them with actual collections required repetitive manual effort every month. Multiple versions of reports were circulated, business team leads were contacted individually, reminder emails were drafted manually and separate communications were required for Portfolio Leads, HOD reviews and follow up cycles. As a result, energy to be invested in collection strategy was getting wasted.

≥100%
Over-achieving
On Target

95 - 99%
Near Target
Minor gap

<95%
Below Target
Intervention needed

Future ETA
Pending
Carry-forward



*Figure 4.3 ETA vs Collections Analytics Dashboard
(all figures and names are dummy)*

✓ PROJECT HIGHLIGHT

The ETA vs Collections framework evolved beyond an analytical dashboard into a reusable operational solution. Its practical value and scalability resulted in another intern from PPSL Department (RA) being assigned to me so that he could understand the automation logic and workflow implementation, enabling knowledge transfer and supporting future adoption of the solution.

	A	B	C	D	E
1	GLOBAL SETTINGS				
2	Setting	Value			
3	ManagementEmail	tarana.pgdm27g@greatlakes.edu.in			
4	SenderName	Collections Team			
5					
6	EMAIL 1 — HOD + POD Leads (Start of Month)				
7	Sent to HOD + all POD leads at start of month. Add Finance/others as CC if needed.				
8	Name	Email	To / CC	Include?	
9	HOD — Anshul	tarana.pgdm27g@greatlakes.edu.in	To	Yes	
10	AS		CC	Yes	
11	AT		CC	Yes	
12	DS		CC	Yes	
13	SS		CC	Yes	
14	SV		CC	Yes	
15	SK		CC	Yes	
16	TR		CC	Yes	
17					
18					
19					

Figure 4.4 Configurable Email Generation Interface

4.4 Business Impact

30 hrs Saved per month <i>4 day cycle → real-time</i>	1 click To generate 4 email types <i>Was: manual per stakeholder</i>	Any month Selectable from dashboard <i>Historical data retrievable</i>	2 teams Adopted framework <i>Primary + PPSL RA (replicated)</i>
---	--	--	---

Thus, from manual generation of reports after creating Pivots and assembling data from various places, the team now only gets email sent to whomsoever it may concern directly and the data can also be compiled as there is an added function of choosing which month's data is required along with the email ids typed out once in the Config sheet.



Scan to access the ETA Analytics & Automation Repository

CHAPTER 5: EXECUTIVE REPORTING & DEBTOR MIS TRANSFORMATION

5.1 From Collection Operations to Executive Decision Support

Every month, debtor information from multiple businesses had to be compiled into a standardised Management Information System (MIS) that provided leadership with a comprehensive overview of collections performance, ageing movement, provisioning exposure and working capital indicators. Preparing this MIS required not only technical accuracy but also business interpretation. This marked a transition from operational execution to executive reporting. (prepared by Mr. Amandeep Singh for all of Collections' team)

Executive Perspective

The dashboard consolidated critical finance indicators into a single management view, reducing dependence on multiple spreadsheets while enabling faster strategic reviews.

5.2 Strategic Questions Addressed by Debtor MIS

- Which businesses contributed most significantly to receivables?
- Which portfolios demonstrated improving collection trends?
- Which ageing buckets required immediate attention?
- Which accounts contributed disproportionately to provisioning exposure?
- Which business units required focused governance reviews?

5.3 Working Capital Metrics Monitored

KPI 1
Debtor Exposure
Monthly

KPI 2
DSO
By vertical

KPI 3
Collection %
vs target

KPI 4
PDD
Provisioning

KPI 5
Ageing Movement
Bucket migration

KPI 6
GL Reconciliation
Matched/unmatched

Sum of Value	Column Labels					
Row Labels	Apr	May	June	July	(blank)	Grand Total
Auto		1,15,15,306	67,13,913	25,78,329	-7,425	#####
CDIT+BFSI POD	2,36,000	2,42,80,886	#####	#####	#####	#####
D2C POD		5,43,16,193	#####	#####	-	#####
FMCG - South POD		24,57,543	16,37,299	57,90,978	-	98,85,820
FMCG North POD		98,81,681	76,42,930	71,84,405	#####	#####
FMCG West POD		4,01,931	#####	83,29,339	-	#####
Govt & Telco		2,55,77,110	#####	#####		#####
Grand Total	2,36,000	#####	#####	#####	#####	#####

Figure 5.1 Strategic Ageing Analysis Pivot Table

5.4 VBA Based Remarks Generation Utility

Another time consuming component of monthly MIS preparation I could identify was the Remarks Generation. Every portfolio required management remarks explaining the movement in its receivable balance: which customers' balances had aged adversely, which ETAs had been received, what the net change in the book implied for DSO and provisioning. This commentary needed to be consistent in format, precise in language and cross referenced against the preliminary dataset, a task that took approximately 10 hours each month.

I thus advanced by automating this VBA utility to eliminate this cycle entirely. The tool reads the preliminary MIS dataset, applies predefined business logic, flags balances above 90 days with customer names, notes ETA status (received or not), records MoM movements and generates the complete commentary for every portfolio in under 1 minute, formatted directly into the correct MIS cells, all done with a click of a button inserted.

Baseline time estimates were recorded during my first two weeks by directly timing each process and cross validating with my reporting manager Mr. Amandeep Singh. Post automation timings were measured across two live monthly cycles in April and May 2026 for all automations.

4 hrs Previous monthly effort <i>Manual drafting + cross-checking</i>	< 1 min After VBA automation <i>Single Excel button press</i>	99.6% Time reduction <i>Verified against baseline</i>	100% Format consistency <i>Eliminates analyst variation</i>
--	---	--	--

Y	Z	AA	AB	AC	
Figures in Rs. Crores					
15th April	21st April	30th April	30-May	NO ETA or Post May'26	Remarks
1.0	3.7	2.8	9.4	3.9	More than 90 Days: GroupM-4.91 Cr (ETA-2.57Cr b 1.12 Cr (ETA- 1.12 Cr), Interactive Avenues -0.40 C April'26)
-	-	-	-	9.7	More than 90 Days: Less than 90 days: Unbilled (ETA April 26)
4.0	2.5	2.0	3.6	2.5	More than 90 Days: Jungle Games - 0.47Cr (No ET 0.15Cr in April), PLUG IN DIGITAL - 0.14Cr (ETA-0.14
-	-	-	-	6.7	More than 90 Days: Less than 90 days: Unbilled (ETA April 26)
1.1	-	1.3	7.6	0.3	More than 90 Days: MH DGIPR-3.54Cr (ETA-No ETA) K SWAMY -0.38Cr (ETA-0.38Cr in April), MP-DIPR-0 MCD-DIRECTORATE- 0.23 Cr (ETA-0.23Cr in April), N 0.05Cr in April), UK-DIPR-0.13Cr(ETA-0.08Cr in Ma Less than 90 days: DAVP-1.27Cr (ETA-1.27Cr in Ma
-	-	-	-	2.0	More than 90 Days: Less than 90 days: Unbilled (ETA April 26)
6.1	6.2	6.1	20.5	25.0	
-	0.2	-	-	0.0	More than 90 Days: More Retail - 0.11Cr (ETA April Less than 90 days: Yes Bank 0.09 Cr(ETA April'26)

Figure 5.2 Automated Remarks Generation Utility

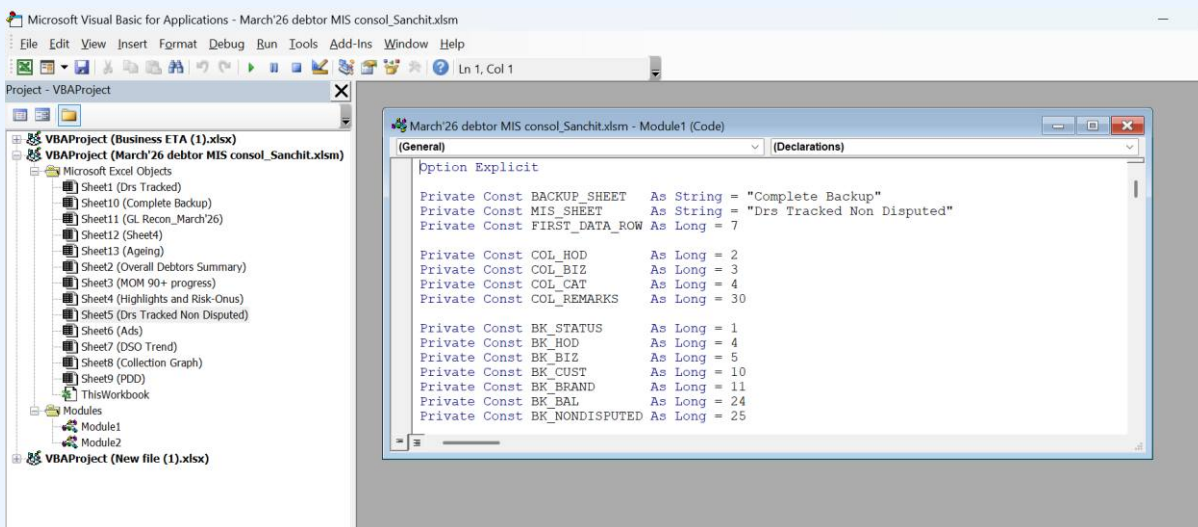


Figure 5.3 VBA Macros coded

✓ PROJECT HIGHLIGHT

The VBA solution converted a repetitive monthly reporting activity into an automated workflow capable of generating business ready commentary with minimal manual intervention. Beyond efficiency gains, the solution improved reporting standardisation and reduced dependency on manual drafting. (The Yellow Part is generated with the click of a Button in Excel)

Chapter Highlights:

- ✓ Executive Debtors Dashboard developed and maintained
- ✓ Exposure to monthly management reporting cycles
- ✓ Practical application of DSO and PDD analysis
- ✓ VBA automation for remarks generation – operationally deployed
- ✓ Standardisation of recurring reporting activities



Scan to access the Executive Debtors MIS Repository

CHAPTER 6: MANUAL PROCESSES TO INTELLIGENT AUTOMATION

PART A: INTERNAL WORKFLOW TICKETING SYSTEM

6.1 Business Problem and its Solution

As collection activities expanded across multiple stakeholders, tracking ownership and pending actions became increasingly difficult. Traditional spreadsheet based follow up mechanisms lacked accountability and everyone could see what others were assigned, making it challenging for managers to obtain a consolidated view of work allocation. Thus, at the initiative of General Manager Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal, Sadakshya (another intern from Universal AI University, Mumbai (B.Tech)) and I collaborated to create the Internal Workflow and Ticketing Management System. (Both reporting to the GM) The system was built to be simple enough for the entire team to adopt without training and structured enough to provide the visibility the existing informal system could not.

No Ownership Challenge 1 Tasks unassigned or lost	No Visibility Challenge 2 Managers lacked overview	Manual Follow-up Challenge 3 Fragmented coordination	Ticketing System Solution Centralised governance
---	--	--	--



6.2 Role Based Architecture

Unlike conventional trackers, the solution incorporated role-based access. Managers obtained visibility across the complete ticket portfolio while assignees could access only the activities assigned to them. This ensured confidentiality without compromising transparency.

MANAGER VIEW

- ✓ Full portfolio visibility
- ✓ All ticket statuses
- ✓ Assignee workload overview
- ✓ Priority flagging
- ✓ Completion tracking

ASSIGNEE VIEW

- ✓ Personal task queue only
- ✓ Own ticket statuses
- ✓ ETA and priority visibility
- ✓ Status update access
- ✓ Confidential segregation

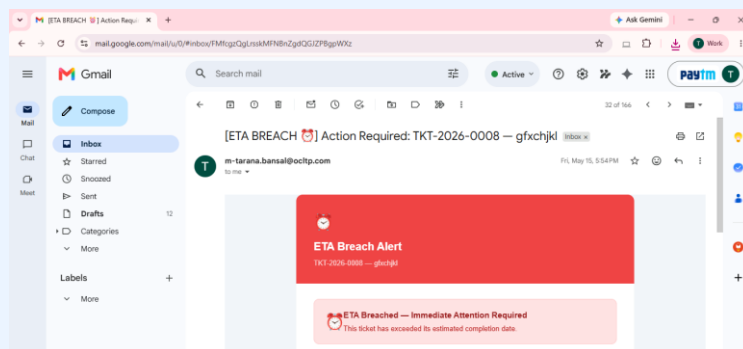


Figure 6.2 ETA Breach Alert

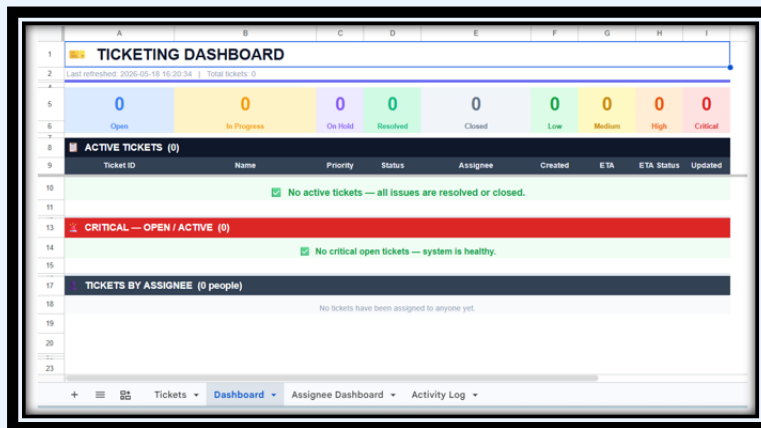
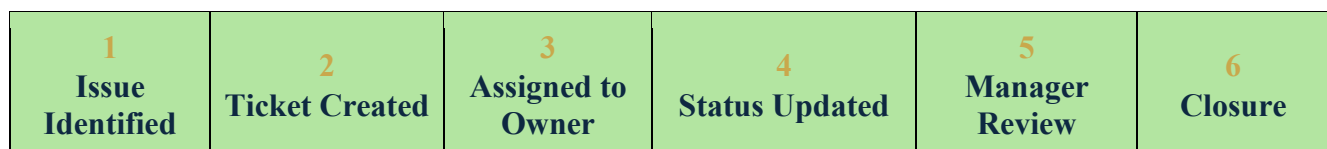


Figure 6.3 Ticketing Dashboard (2)

6.3 Ticket Lifecycle



Business Impact

The framework reduced dependency on manual coordination while enabling managers to monitor progress through a centralised dashboard. By converting informal follow up chains into a structured ticketing workflow, accountability converted directly as collections operations, ensuring every action item had a clear owner, timeline and escalation path.



Scan to access the Internal Ticketing and Workflow Management System

PART B: RECOVERY NOTICE AUTOMATION

6.4 Automation as a Business Enabler

As documented in Chapter 1, recovery notices had previously required 3 hours each: SAP documentation download, annexure table construction, notice formatting and dispatch preparation. At 40 notices per quarter, this represented 120 hours of quarterly effort, approximately 40 hours per month.

The automation solution, built using YAMM (Yet Another Mail Merge) integrated with Google Sheets, standardised all notice templates with dynamic fields. Customer name, outstanding amounts and the annexure table were now populated automatically from the source dataset. The SAP documentation download remains a manual step (a platform constraint that cannot be bypassed), but everything else, notice body, annexure table, formatting and dispatch queue, is generated with a single click.

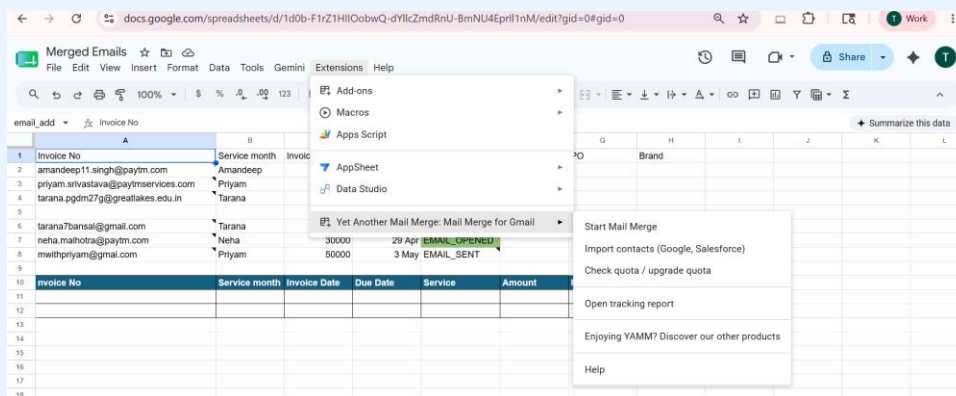


Figure 6.4 Customer Recovery Communication via YAMM

40

Notices per quarter
Consistent volume

3 hrs → 30 min

Per notice
83% time reduction

~100 hrs

Saved per quarter
≈ 2.5 FTE-weeks

1 click

To generate + queue all
SAP download remains

6.5 Recovery Notice Automation

The first automation initiative originated from recovery operations. Preparation of recovery notices required repeated customisation for different customers while ensuring correct documentation was attached with every communication. Standardised templates were developed and edited as required. Instead of recreating notices every cycle manually, I created customer specific drafts that could be reused while preserving consistency all accounts. This was achieved by automating the same system as there are different formats for different customers.

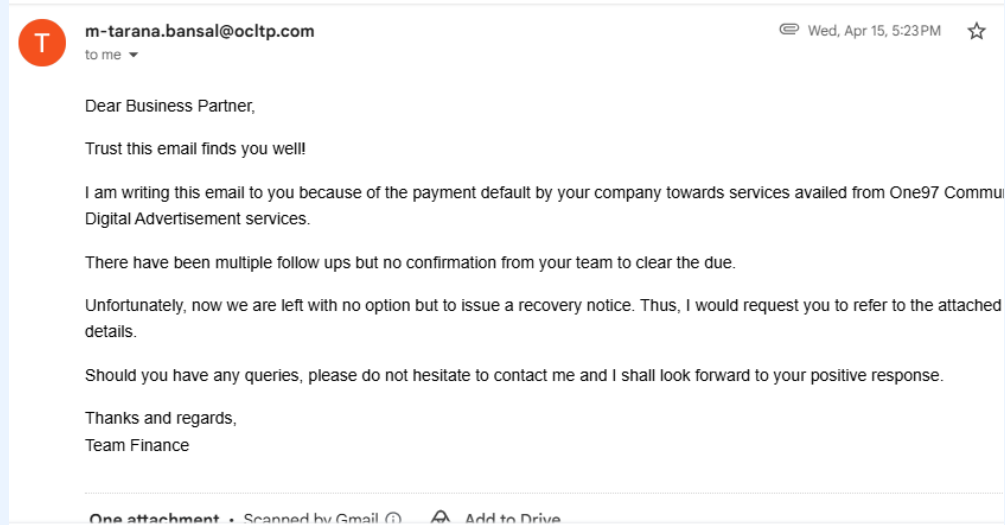


Figure 6.5 Customer Recovery Automation Main (Gmails)

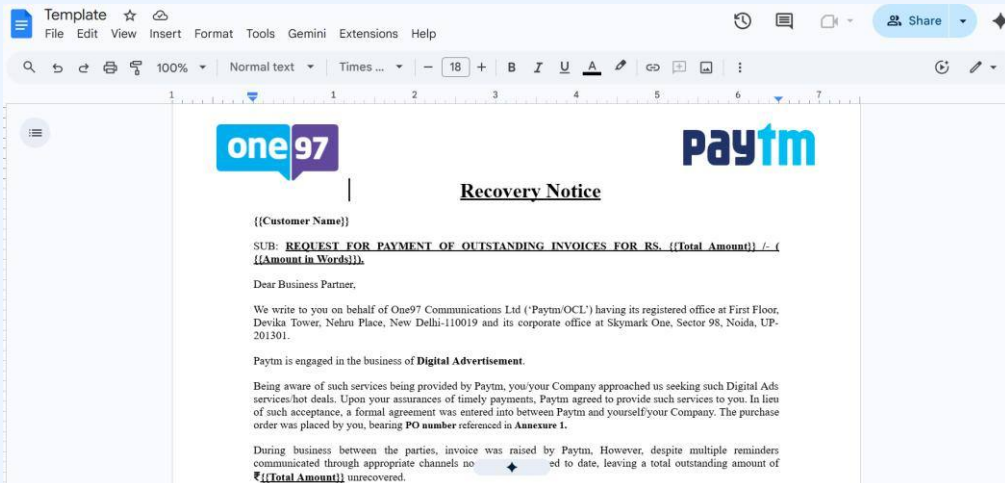


Figure 6.6 Recovery Notice template that customised for all customers

Scan to access the Recovery Automation



CHAPTER 7: PAYMENT APPLICATION AND RECONCILIATION

7.1 Beyond Collections: Ensuring Cash Realisation

Recovering money from customers is only the collection stage of the receivables' lifecycle. The financial record is not closed until that payment is correctly identified, matched to the invoice, validated for TDS and short-payment discrepancies, reconciled against the SAP balance and formally knocked off in the general ledger.

The matching key is the UTR (Unique Transaction Reference) number, a bank transaction identifier present in every payment receipt that uniquely links an inbound cash flow to a specific customer transaction. Any excess amount received beyond the invoice value is routed to the OCL team within the same department for credit against future invoices and added to the relevant POD lead's account as Future ETA (ensuring collections of other months is not lost in the reconciliation process and remains visible separately).

7.2 End to End Payment Application Process

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Customer Payment	Bank Receipt	Transaction ID	Invoice Mapping	TDS Verification	Amount Allocation	GL Reconciliation	Receivable Closure

7.3 Daily Verification Activities

Category	Condition	Action Required
Full Match	Received = Invoice amount exactly	Confirm and close in SAP, update MIS
Short Payment	Received < Invoice amount	Document difference, notify customer, carry forward balance
TDS Adjustment	Amount deducted for tax at source	Validate TDS certificate, reconcile gross and net
Unapplied Receipt	No matching invoice found	Hold pending, contact customer for reference
Over-payment	Received > Invoice amount	Route excess to OCL team, credit as Future ETA

Figure 7.1 Payment Application Tracker

The March 2026 GL Reconciliation confirmed a Matched status against a ₹4.7 Cr GL balance, meaning every rupee in the reported debtors figure was accounted for at the transaction level. An unreconciled debtors balance renders DSO, PDD and coverage ratio calculations unreliable.

- ✓ Payment realisation process and invoice mapping protocols
- ✓ Short payment verification and TDS validation procedures
- ✓ Reconciliation controls and financial reporting accuracy
- ✓ Relationship between cash collections and working capital reporting

CHAPTER 8: ORGANISATIONAL VALUE CREATED & PERSONAL LEARNINGS

8.1 Quantified Impact

The initiatives documented in this report are evaluated below against their pre automation baselines. Timing estimates for the baseline state were recorded during the first weeks of the internship and validated through direct observation and conversation with the direct reporting manager, Ms. Priyam Srivastava

Initiative	Baseline (Before)	Outcome (After)	Saving
ETA vs Collections Framework	4 day monthly data assembly, manual VLOOKUP across 3+ files	Real time, collections entered as received, auto refresh	30 hrs/month
ETA Email Automation	Manual drafting of 4 email types per cycle per stakeholder	One click generation, auto populated from data	8 hrs/month
VBA Remarks Engine	4 hrs manual commentary drafting per MIS cycle	< 1 minute per month via Excel button	4 hrs/month
Recovery Notice Automation	3 hrs per notice × 40 per quarter = 40 hrs/month equivalent	30 min per notice (SAP download remains)	33 hrs/month
Internal Ticketing System	Informal email follow ups, no ownership tracking	Centralised lifecycle with breach alerts and role based access	Ongoing
TOTAL	80+ hrs/month consumed by process overhead	—	80 hrs/month saved

In 2 months, I was told that the value created was maximised by 3 of us interns, compared to others. We were also said to be the most hardworking and eager to learn interns. This is corroborated through the initiatives undertaken during the internship, not merely through a summary of tasks performed, but also as responsibilities evolved from operational execution to process enhancement, analytical reporting and Automation development. I was also invited to review meetings and took part in Automation Friday (a zoom call where your automation is portrayed for all others in different RA teams to learn from).

Talking statistics, my LinkedIn post was liked by Paytm itself, got 95,925 impressions, 865 likes and comments from 38 people (including only 5 from the GLIM community). This also led to 1,344 profile views and an increased 163 followers along with me appearing in approximately 70 profile viewers weekly until now.

The team culture was equally telling. For the quarterly celebration, colleagues contributed on my behalf without letting me know and told me that it was arranged through a special permission, a gesture only

revealed when the other intern, Sadakshya, paid separately, making it apparent the company had not covered the cost. It was an unscripted measure of the relationships and regard built over two months.

8.2 Skills & Knowledge Acquired

Domain	Capabilities Acquired
Finance & Receivables	End to end ageing analysis, DSO monitoring across verticals, PDD (ECL framework), Working capital management, Payment application, GL reconciliation, Collection forecasting, Debtor management
Analytics & Reporting	Executive MIS design and maintenance, KPI framework development, Variance analysis, Pivot table architecture, V-Lookup, Management commentary generation, Business interpretation of financial data
Automation & Technology	VBA (Excel), Google Apps Script, YAMM mail merge, SAP AR workflows & Dashboard development, Process standardisation, Configurable email engine design
Governance & Communication	Stakeholder communication management, Escalation framework design, Ticketing system architecture, Cross functional coordination, Management reporting, Enterprise documentation standards

8.3 Contributions Delivered

Deliverable	Status	Scope of Adoption
ETA vs Collections Framework + Email Automation	LIVE	Revenue Assurance team (primary), independently replicated by PPSL RA intern
VBA Remarks Generation Utility	LIVE	Deployed into monthly MIS cycle, in active use
Recovery Notice Automation	LIVE	Collections team quarterly cycle, 40 notices/quarter (both YAMM and Apps Script)
Internal Workflow & Ticketing System	LIVE	GM, direct reports and full collections team
Executive Debtors MIS (enhanced)	LIVE	Monthly senior leadership review, enhanced with VBA remarks

8.4 Professional Insights: What the Internship Actually Taught

Two months is not a long time. But it was long enough to understand something that no classroom module had quite articulated for me before: finance, at its most impactful, is not about producing reports; it is about the conditions under which better decisions can be made faster.

The ageing reports in the first weeks did not just become Excel files to me, they became indicators of working capital efficiency and each bucket movement was a signal about customer relationship, a billing cycle or an escalation that had not happened. The automation frameworks I built were not about efficiency for its own sake, they were about giving the team back the time to think about those critical questions which were pondered upon in family time, rather than spending it assembling the data required to ask them.

The people across the team, including but not all, Mr. Sanchit Aggarwal, Mr. Amandeep Singh, Mr. Ankit Chandra, Mr. Ashwini, Mr. Mayank Bansal, Ms. Priyam Srivastava, were extremely generous with their knowledge and their time. They did not treat the internship as an administrative requirement. They gave real work, real access and real feedback. The satisfaction of seeing the frameworks actually deployed and being told by colleagues that they had learned new and better ways to work was the most concrete possible confirmation that the efforts, long nights, deadlines and no work-life balance had been worthwhile.

I also started exploring more and found myself intrigued with the newfound intelligence. Below is a published report (dummy) showing the automations named Collections Intelligence Command Centre to portray my work better and easily. Just scan the QR and glimpse into 73.5% of what I did in 2 months at Paytm.

Closing Reflection

A finance internship could have been spent observing. The choice was to contribute, to find the inefficiencies, understand them deeply enough to fix them properly and build solutions that would work without me present. The motive was: 'did I leave it better than I found it?' The answer, here, is yes.

MANAGEMENT INNOVATION

Digital Extension of the Internship Project

Beyond the report, a live digital platform was developed to enable stakeholders to interact with the analytical models and automation solutions created during the internship. The platform allows users to simulate working capital scenarios, generate management commentary, assess collection performance and experience automation workflows through an integrated executive interface.



Experience the Collections
Intelligence Command Centre

RISKS, LIMITATIONS & PERSONAL LEARNINGS

Risks & Limitations

Not every part of what I built is without vulnerability. Being honest about this is as important as documenting what worked. The most persistent risk across all solutions is structural fragility within the tools themselves. The ETA vs Collections framework and VBA Remarks Engine both live inside Google Sheets and Excel files, which means a renamed column, a deleted tab or an accidental overwrite can silently break everything downstream. I experienced similar problems during the internship and fixed them quickly, but the risk remains, because others might not be able to understand what truly was done. None of these solutions are version controlled in any formal sense.

The YAMM based recovery notice automation carries a quota constraint of 50 (free version), which could become a bottleneck if notice volumes increase or if the tool is extended to other verticals. The Apps Script implementation I built in parallel does not have this limitation and could be treated as the primary long term tool, with YAMM as backup. The Internal Ticketing System, though adopted well by the team, was built on a personal Google account. It was transferred, but if the main account becomes inaccessible, so does the entire governance system the team now relies on. This was flagged during handover and remedied instantly.

The deepest limitation, however, is key person dependency. I designed all five frameworks. The logic, the architecture, the business rules embedded in the scripts, most of that lived in my head. The knowledge transfer to the PPSL intern was the first real test of whether someone else could replicate the work from documentation alone. It took two full days, which told me the documentation was not good enough. An SOP written during the internship, not after it, would have changed that. This is also corroborated as I got a call from the team on 7th June 2026, for an automation and a glitch.

Finally, the SAP export step remains the one bottleneck I could not address. Every automation begins with a manual SAP download because there is no accessible external interface. That single manual dependency limits how real time the entire Collections Intelligence Ecosystem can actually be.

Personal Learnings

The most scalable technical solution I could have built for ETA vs Collections was a Python based system with a proper database. I chose Sheets and Apps Script because the team had Sheets open every day. That choice is the reason two teams are using the framework now instead of zero.

What I learned about myself is harder to articulate but more important: I am most effective when I am building things that make other people's work better, not just completing tasks. I also am intrigued by newer concepts and thus published the report on Google Sites and currently working on platforms like GitHub and Lovable AI. This has also given me ideas and enthusiasm to continue working out more things on my own, as there is quite a lot to learn, including an increased interest in Finance books.

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR PAYTM

- **Migrate from Sheets Based Automation to a Version Safe Centralised AR Platform:** The ETA vs Collections framework and VBA Remarks Engine are currently in daily use, but they carry structural fragility: multiuser editing creates conflicts during live review cycles, etc. The recommendation is to migrate the deployment environment. A custom Google AppSheet application would preserve the existing logic while adding version control, access management and device independence. The investment would be minimal because the frameworks already exist anyway.
- **Build an AR Automation SOP Before the Next Internship Cohort:** The PPSL intern and I were unsure as to how we should proceed, the only dictate given was to Automate. Having an SOP and clear guidelines would significantly help, as I could find my way, but he couldn't.
- **Establish a Clear Internal Policy for AI Tool Usage:** During the internship, I used Claude and ChatGPT for formula and code generation, however, was forcepoint blocked sometimes even when not adding any sensitive information. Others, however, could just upload the whole file: this usage was informal and undocumented, with no policy governing what data could be passed to external tools. Given that Revenue Assurance handles sensitive receivables data, a clear internal guideline would allow the team to use these tools confidently and at scale, rather than informally and individually. (if possible, provide free versions other than partnerships)
- **Establish a Scheduled SAP Data Feed to Eliminate the Manual Export Bottleneck:** This is the single largest residual bottleneck in the Collections Intelligence Ecosystem and it cannot be addressed within the existing architecture. Thus, a scheduled SAP data feed, for instance, a nightly automated export to a shared Drive folder that the Sheets and VBA frameworks then read automatically, would make the entire ecosystem genuinely real time. The technical scope is modest and can likely be configured within SAP's existing scheduling capabilities. The operational impact would be significant.
- If possible, hire Gen-Z employees and respect newer ways as much as experience (Paytm gives a lot more weightage to years worked in corporate, compared to if newer employees know better ways for the same processes).

FINAL CONCLUSION

The internship at Paytm provided me with an opportunity to not just experience Finance as a reporting function, but as an ecosystem where analytics, governance and automation collectively influence business performance. Beginning with recovery operations and progressing through ageing analysis, payment application, collection forecasting and executive reporting, the journey demonstrated how interconnected finance processes contribute towards efficient working capital management.

The development of automation frameworks, particularly within ETA governance and management reporting, helped me identify that relatively simple technological interventions can substantially improve operational efficiency while strengthening decision making capabilities. An equally important measure was exposure to cross functional collaboration and continuous review mechanisms, which reinforced the importance of stakeholder communication and iterative improvement in enterprise finance environments.

Rather than concluding as a learning experience alone, this internship concluded as a demonstration of how Finance Analytics and process Automation can together create scalable Organisational impact.



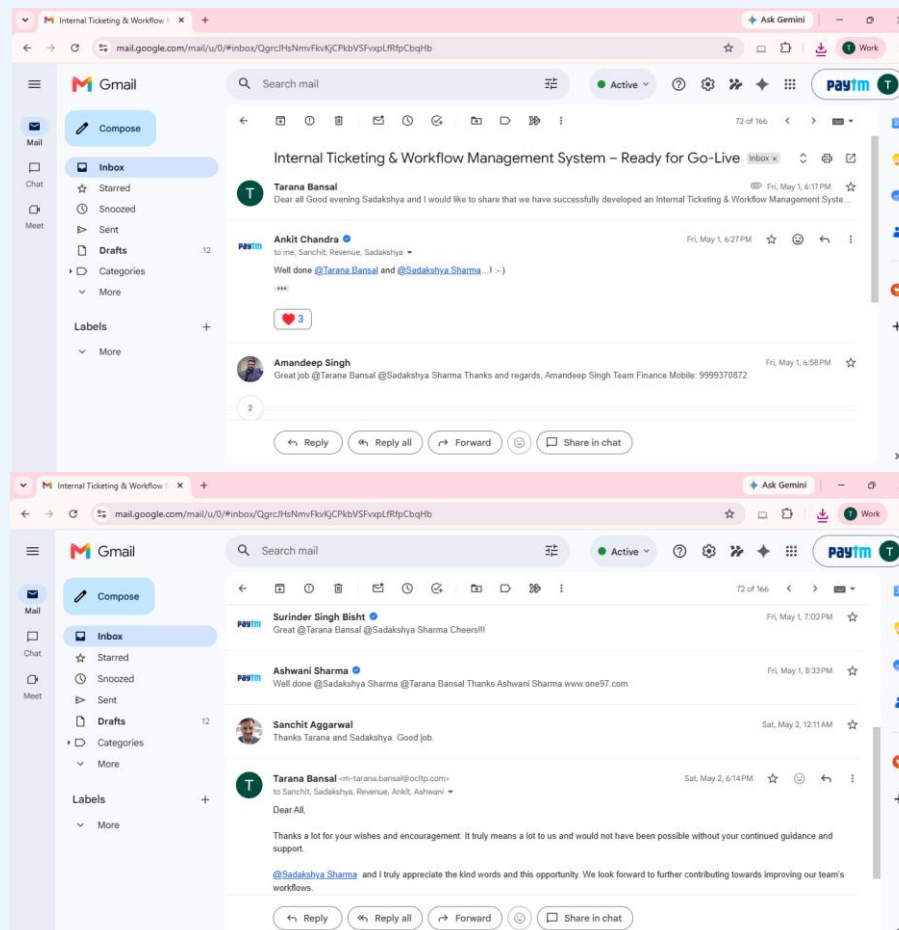
APPENDIX: QR REPOSITORY

Combined Google Drive Project Repository containing: ETA Files, MIS, VBA Tool, Automation and Supporting Documents.



QR Code for Google Drive Repository

GLIMPSES OF ACHIEVEMENT



BIBLIOGRAPHY

- One97 Communications Limited. (2025). *Annual report 2024 - 25*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from https://paytm.com/document/ir/annual-reports/Paytm_Annual_Report_2024---25.pdf
- Reserve Bank of India. (2025). *Annual report 2024 - 25*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/AnnualReportPublications.aspx?year=2026>
- Reserve Bank of India. (2024). *Guidelines on expected credit loss (ECL) based provisioning for advances*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_CircularIndexDisplay.aspx
- National Payments Corporation of India. (2026). *UPI product statistics and digital payments data*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://www.npci.org.in/product/upi/product-statistics>
- PwC India. (2024). *FinTech in India: Powering financial inclusion and digital transformation*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://www.pwc.in/industries/financial-services/fintech.html>
- EY. (2024). *The future of finance: Intelligent automation in finance functions*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from https://www.ey.com/en_gl
- Outlook Business. (2026, June). *UPI market share: PhonePe, Google Pay and Paytm concentration drops to 87% as smaller players gain ground*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://www.outlookbusiness.com/>
- TaxGuru. (2024, January 31). *RBI restricts Paytm Payments Bank from 29th February 2024*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://taxguru.in/rbi/rbi-restricts-paytm-payments-bank-29th-february-2024.html>
- News 18. (2025, April 2026). *RBI cancels Paytm Payments Bank License*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://www.news18.com/business/banking-finance/rbi-cancels-paytm-payments-bank-licence-what-it-means-for-customers-wallets-and-deposits-ws-l-10055931.html>
- OpenAI. (2026). *ChatGPT: Capabilities and usage documentation*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://platform.openai.com/login>
- Anthropic. (2026). *Claude: Model card and documentation*. Retrieved June 18, 2026, from <https://claude.com/product/overview>

COURSE MAPPING (ANNEXURE 4)

Problem Statement	FMDM	MaE	MM-1	OB1	SMDM	Business Communication	KY	EEP	CMA	MaE-2	MM-II	BECGS	POM	BA	OB-II	SM	BRM	FM	OTDM	BI	HRM	CAT
Receivables data lacks a single source of truth, causing 2+ days of manual consolidation before analysis begins	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE
ETA and actual collections have no automated reconciliation, making mid month review difficult	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE
Recovery notice generation is fully manual, causing 120 hours of avoidable quarterly effort on standard content	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE
MIS commentary has no standardised logic, producing inconsistent and analyst dependent executive reports	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE
Follow up communication has no automation, reducing stakeholder emails to a repetitive activity	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE
Collections department lacks a role based accountability structure, leaving ownership informal and deadline breaches unescalated	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE
Collections has no performance stratification, causing uniform follow up regardless of achievement level	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE	FALSE	FALSE	TRUE	TRUE	FALSE	TRUE

END
